



Cloud Readiness Assessment – Part 1

Platform Direction & Path Forward

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#	Agenda Item	Indicative Timing
1	Executive Summary	10 mins
2	Project Scope	10 mins
3	Why Cloud, Why Now?	15 mins
4	Opportunities	10 mins
5	Your Estate	15 mins
6	Business Drivers	10 mins
Break		15 mins
7	Hyperscaler Weighted Scoring	15 mins
8	Business and Application Fit	15 mins
9	Cost Comparison	30 mins
10	Overall Hyperscaler Recommendation	15 mins
11	Readiness	15 mins
12	Moving Forward and Part 2	10 mins
13	Conclusion and Next Steps	5 mins



Executive Summary

Our Understanding of DMG

Global publishing leader operating at massive digital scale DMG Media owns flagship brands including Daily Mail, MailOnline, Metro, The i Paper and New Scientist, reaching ~108M monthly users globally, with MailOnline one of the world's largest English-language news platforms. This positions the group as one of the largest consumer media platforms in Europe, with significant audience reach across the UK, US and Australia.

Clear pivot to a subscription-led, customer-centric model The organisation is executing a "One Daily Mail" strategy targeting 1M digital subscribers within three years, building on a base of 325K+ subscribers globally following the launch of Mail+. This marks a strategic shift from a predominantly advertising-led model toward diversified, recurring reader revenue.

Data-driven experimentation underpinning growth strategy Digital subscription growth is being driven through a test-and-learn model, with continuous experimentation across pricing, content, and user journeys. The business is leveraging platforms like Piano to enable propensity modelling, segmentation, and conversion optimisation, embedding data into commercial decision-making.

Operating at global content scale with highly industrialised production MailOnline attracts 120M+ global users and publishes ~1,500 articles per day, supported by large, distributed editorial teams. This level of output reflects highly industrialised content operations, requiring scalable platforms to support publishing, distribution, and audience engagement in real time.

Market-leading engagement across digital news platforms MailOnline consistently ranks as the number 1 commercial news site in the UK, with industry-leading reach and strong time spent metrics. This level of engagement provides a strong foundation for monetisation through both advertising and subscription models.

Next phase: AI-led growth and personalisation requires modern platforms DMG Media is investing in AI-enabled editorial tooling, analytics, apps, newsletters, and digital product innovation to support growth in subscriptions and engagement. As these capabilities scale, the need increases for integrated data platforms, real-time decisioning, and flexible infrastructure to support experimentation, personalisation, and global delivery.

DMG Media has built a scaled digital publisher, the next phase of growth will be defined by its ability to standardise, automate, and operationalise data and AI at scale

Key Findings – Opportunities and Risks

Opportunities (With Transformation) "From Complexity to Capability"	Risks (If No Action Taken) "Yesterday's Platform, Tomorrow's Problem"
1. AI-enabled growth and personalisation at scale • Enable data-driven content, automation, and decisioning • Move from isolated AI use cases → platform-wide capability 2. Cost optimisation through utilisation alignment • Match cost to demand: Eliminate overprovisioning and shift from fixed capacity to consumption-based infrastructure • Embed FinOps discipline: Drive cost visibility, accountability, and continuous rightsizing across teams • Activate cloud cost levers: Optimise through storage tiering, platform modernisation, and application rationalisation • Realise savings progressively: Deliver early wins, then scale optimisation and transformation over time 3. Standardisation and simplification • Unified platform across brands • Reduced operational complexity and faster delivery 4. Incremental value delivery (not big bang) • Early wins (e.g. Sydney DC exit, rightsizing) • Ongoing optimisation through migration phases 5. Target Operating Model Alignment • Cloud migration provides a one-time opportunity for standardisation across brands, elimination of silos and reduction in shadow IT. • This allows for optimising against rapid innovation and continuous incremental improvements	1. Doing nothing is not cost-neutral, it creates forced decisions • VMware (Broadcom) → unavoidable cost increase • DC leases & Microsoft EA → renewal locks long-term direction • Hardware → can be extended, but limits future capability 2. Current platform limits future capability, not just scale • Akamai already handles traffic peaks effectively • The challenge two-fold: • is increasing platform complexity, not burst demand • upgrades and new infrastructure results in long-term investment cycles 3. Operational fragmentation limits growth • Multiple teams, tools, and processes across estate • No unified control plane → slower delivery and higher risk 4. Skills and operating model misalignment • Estate optimised for traditional infrastructure • Not aligned to cloud-native and an AI-enabled operating model 5. Technical Debt: • modernisation necessary to protect the business from risk associated with increasing operational burden and growing number of security vulnerabilities.

Rackspace Overall Recommendation

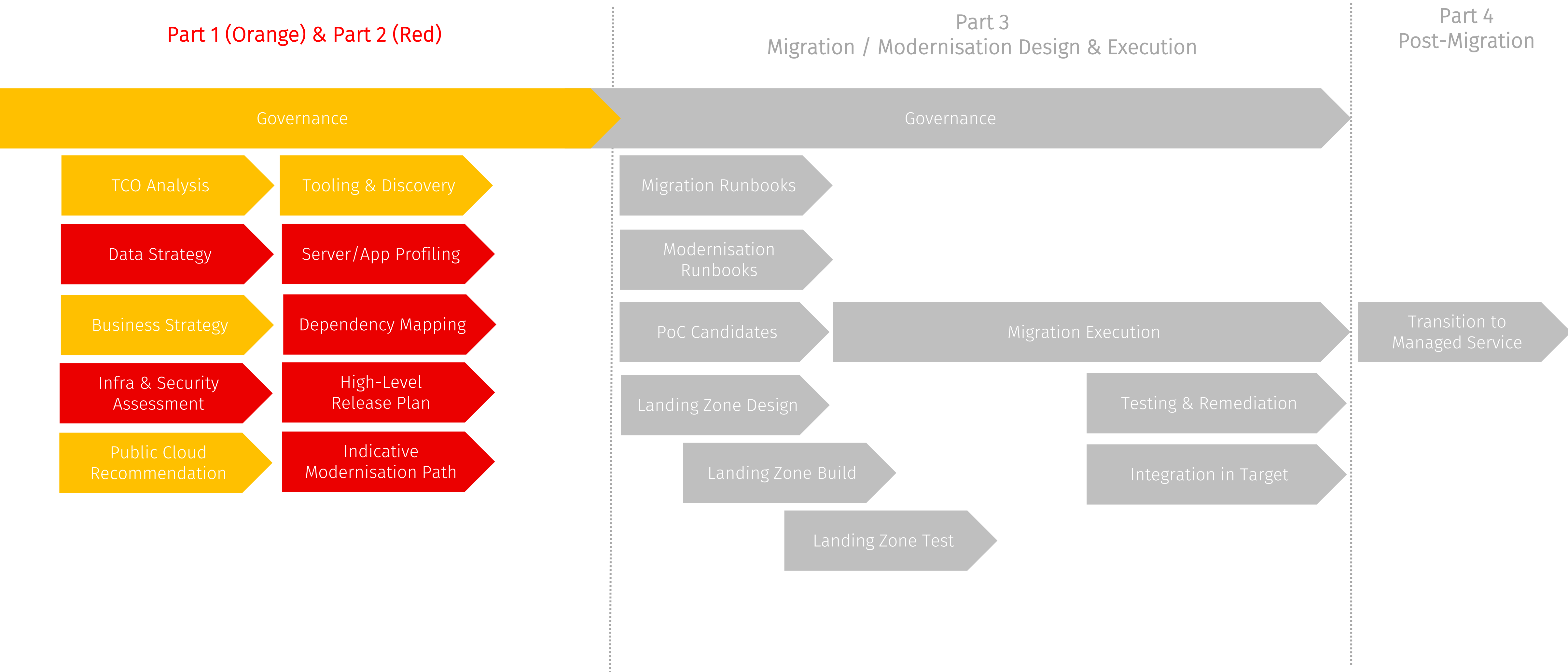
AWS transforms your business with the least disruption, lowest risk, and fastest path to value



Category	1st	2nd	3rd
Application & Technical Fit	• Best fit overall • No refactor required: only platform supporting multicast natively, meaning Atex works as-is. • Broadest support for infrastructure-dependent applications, minimises redesign required before migration.	• Refactor required: Atex must be rewritten from multicast to unicast (added cost, time, and production risk). • Less flexible for legacy application patterns.	• Same refactor requirement as GCP. • More rigid on VM sizing, storage, and tooling.
Business Fit & Operating Model	• Strongest alignment with partner-led, hybrid skills model. • Video streaming + infra already on AWS. • Internal teams have AWS skills. • Largest media partner ecosystem.	• Analytics teams aligned to GCP (valid exception, retained). • Smaller ecosystem, limited enterprise alignment.	• Entra, Sentinel, and M365 add value but are not core to a Linux-heavy estate. • Limited workload alignment today.
3-Year TCO	• £4.60M/yr (2% above GCP). • Balanced sizing (49% vCPU), competitive storage pricing.	• £4.51M/yr (cheapest). • Aggressive rightsizing (32% vCPU)	• zz£5.59M/yr (24% higher). • 53% vCPU sizing, but premium storage and less efficient pricing drive the gap.
Funding, Credits & Commercial Levers	• Strongest indicated position: Migration Acceleration Programme + Enterprise Discount Programme. • Largest co-investment programme available (funded resources, credits, training). • BYOL works with constraints.	• Competitive but lower funding scale. • BYOL more complex (requires dedicated Sole Tenant nodes).	• Best BYOL mechanism (AHB) but limited to 7.7% Windows estate. • Funding position unclear / weaker.
Platform & Connectivity Readiness	• Direct Connect already in place and working. • Leads in weighted performance and reliability scoring. • Largest and most mature marketplace.	• Standard connectivity. • Strong scalability. • Smaller marketplace.	• Standard VPN / ExpressRoute. • Competitive but not leading. Enterprise partner base (Microsoft-centric).
AI & Data Platform	• Bedrock + SageMaker: broad platform play across inference, training, and orchestration.	• Best-in-class analytics (BigQuery, Vertex AI). • Retained for commercial data analytics.	• Azure AI strong but less aligned to use cases.

Project Scope

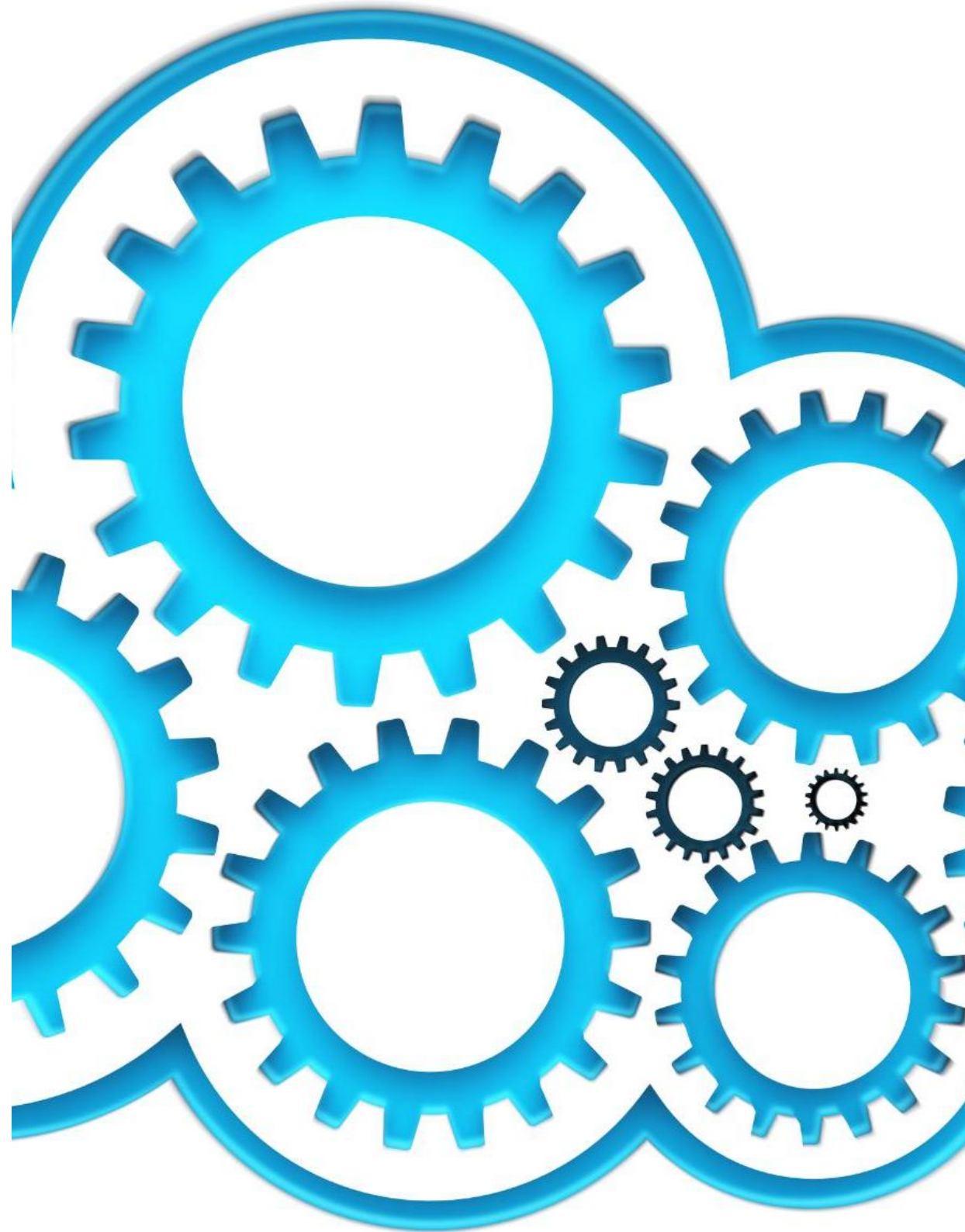
Plan – Cloud Readiness Assessment



What this assessment covers

- **Defines a cloud platform direction aligned to the ambition of reaching 1 million digital subscribers, setting the platform foundation for scalable, data-driven growth**
 - **Outcome:** A clear technology recommendation to support subscription growth, personalisation, content delivery, and global scale
- **Assesses the readiness of the current estate for cloud adoption across applications and infrastructure, with preliminary assessment of security and operational readiness**
 - **Outcome:** A clear view of what is cloud-ready today, what requires remediation, and where gaps remain for Part 2 to address
- **Delivers a cloud-agnostic comparison of AWS, Azure, and GCP using consistent, weighted criteria**
 - **Outcome:** Selection of the right primary platform based on technical fit, business alignment, cost, and commercial position
- **Establishes a 3-year TCO comparison across all three platforms with cost optimisation recommendations**
 - **Outcome:** Financial transparency across platforms, enabling informed decision-making and a foundation for FinOps discipline
- **Profiles 39 applications and maps application-to-infrastructure dependencies across the in-scope estate**
 - **Outcome:** Identification of opportunities for standardisation and simplification, reducing duplication and operational complexity
- **Provides an indicative modernisation pathway**
 - **Outcome:** Directional view of how the estate evolves post-migration, with detailed modernisation analysis to follow in Part 2
- **Recommends a primary cloud platform and high-level transformation direction**
 - **Outcome:** Executive alignment on platform choice and a clear path into Part 2 execution

Scope Summary



11-week independent Cloud Readiness Assessment

3 datacentres Reading, Slough, Sydney

3,038 servers discovered and independently priced

14,165 vCPUs, 54 TB memory, 1.2 PB storage assessed

39 applications profiled across 9 workshops

88 databases Oracle and SQL Server assessed

3 clouds compared using live pricing APIs

5 infrastructure types VMware, Proxmox, physical, appliance, cloud

Why Cloud? Why Now?

The case for acting now

- **Opex model supports platform growth to 1M subscriber goal:** Fixed-capacity on-prem requires large step capacity increases tied to long-term investment schedules or overprovisioning to support additional business capability and step change in subscriber growth. Transitioning to cloud allows on-demand capabilities like serverless + platform-as-a-service which provide rapid scaling and per-minute incremental billing.
- **Target Operating Model Alignment:** cloud migration provides a one-time opportunity for standardisation across brands, elimination of silos and reduction in shadow IT. This allows for optimizing against rapid innovation and continuous incremental improvements.
- **Contracts converging:** DC leases, EA, Broadcom, Oracle all landing inside two years. Each renewal re-locks capital and sets long-term strategy. Pay as you go models allows for greater flexibility.
- **VMware position has changed:** Perpetual licences, expired support. No patches, no new hosts. VCF subscription is the only path forward requiring significant investment.
- **Operational fragmentation limits growth:** 170 staff, 7 areas, different tooling and processes. No consistent control plane increases operational complexity.
- **Technical Debt:** modernisation is necessary to protect the business from risk associated with increasing operational burden and growing number of security vulnerabilities from legacy OS.
- **The cost of staying on-premises will rise** Cloud starts higher however **the key levers to reduce cost sit in cloud, not in the datacentre.**

Opportunities

Quantified opportunities

Modelled in Part 1

- **Oracle modernisation to PostgreSQL** | £45-65K/mo saving (£540-780K/yr) Eliminates £650K/yr support contract. Requires Part 2 assessment. Conversion cost not yet estimated.
- **Windows BYOL** | £7-18K/mo saving depending on cloud Requires active SA. Cost-effective on Azure (AHB). On AWS/GCP only while EA is active (expires May 2027).
- **SQL Server BYOL** | £14-15K/mo saving across all clouds Requires SA confirmation from Bluesource. Cost-effective on all three platforms.
- **Storage tiering** | £10-19K/mo saving depending on cloud 336 TiB non-production moved from SSD to HDD class. No application impact.
- **RTA rightsizing** | Saving TBD (Part 2 to quantify) Many instances significantly overprovisioned. Right-size during migration for immediate saving.

Strategic opportunities

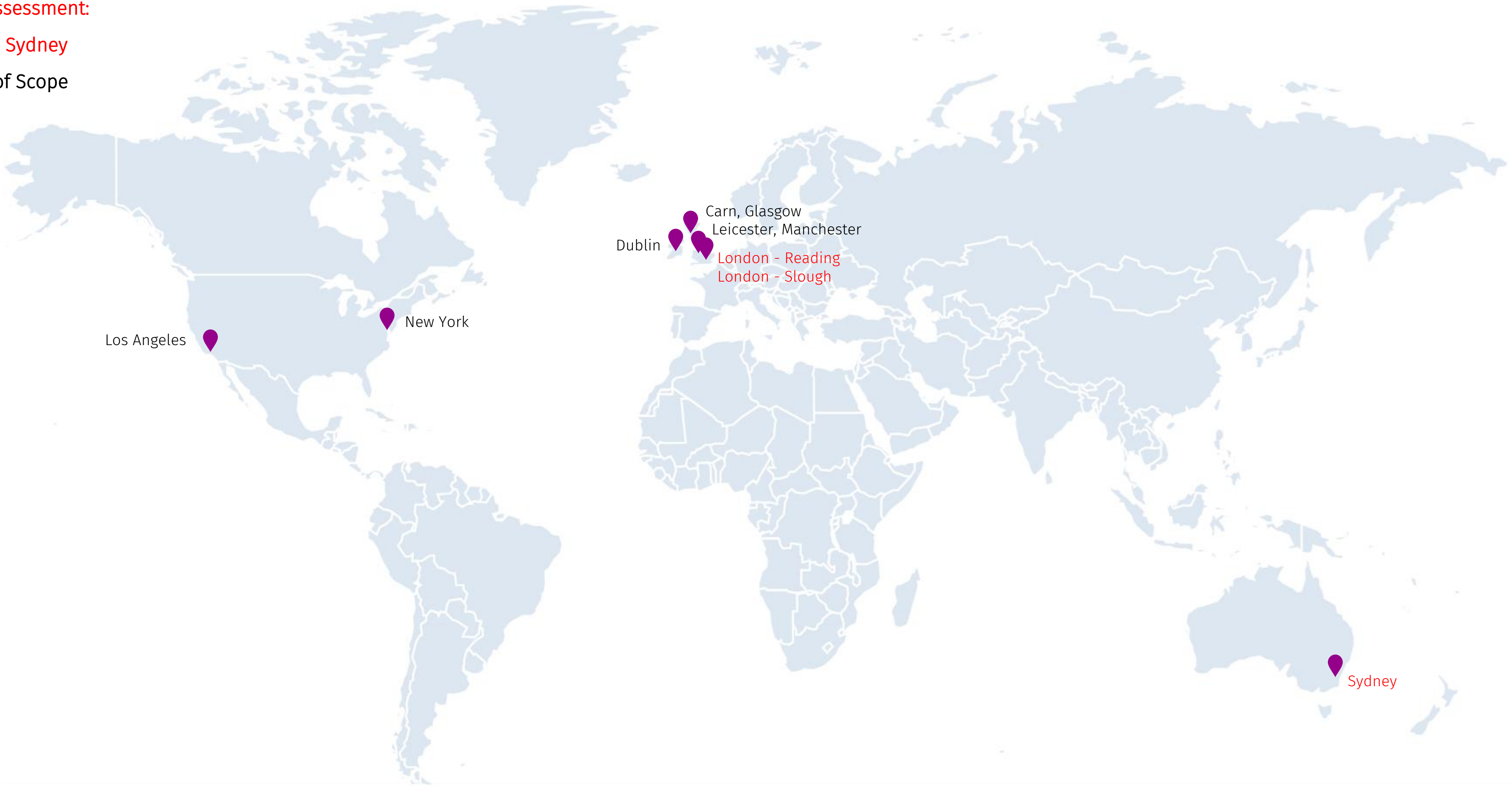
Part 2 to validate

- **Sydney datacentre exit** 4 servers, flexible contract, £40K/yr cost offset. Low-hanging fruit for early migration and savings.
- **Application rationalisation** Lotus Notes (SaaS replacement), Atex 5.5 (32-bit, retire when Atex 6 complete), SolarWinds and Zabbix (replace with cloud-native monitoring). Every app retired is servers removed from migration scope.
- **Load balancer modernisation** F5 (corporate) and Zeus/Ivanti vTM (Mail Online) replaced by cloud-native. No hardware lifecycle, auto-scaling, native integration.
- **Observability consolidation** Replace SolarWinds and Zabbix with a single cloud-native or cloud-agnostic monitoring platform. Consistent across brands.
- **Infrastructure as Code from day one** All cloud provisioning via Terraform or cloud-native equivalent. Reproducible, auditable, eliminates manual configuration errors.
- **API management layer** Decoupling of tightly connected application elements enables future simplification.
- **Akamai > Cloudfront** Customer engagements with measurable performance gain and savings opportunity through CDN.

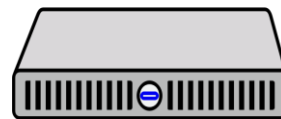
Your Estate
(in scope)

DMG's Global Presence

In Scope for this Assessment:
Reading, Slough, Sydney
Remainder Out of Scope



DMG Inventory Scope – At a Glance

	 PROXMOX	 2937 x  31 x Virtual Appliances  46 x Virtual DBServers				 DBs on Physicals									
Reading	No MOL proxmox In Reading ANL proxmox Reading – TEST ONLY	927 x Linux 	75 x Windows 	6 x Solaris 	4x  	5x 	1x  VMware Horizon	2x 	4x 	3x 	9x  Microsoft SQL Server	 MOL – Prod 6 x DL360 6 x 3par  CHP – Prod 1 x DL360 1 x Primera  Atex – Prod 1 x DL380 1 x Primera	6 x HPE 480 G11	3x  Microsoft SQL Server	
Slough	41 x Proxmox  MOL INT	1779 x Linux 	157 x Windows 	6 x Solaris 	6x  	8x 	1x  VMware Horizon		10x	6x 	12x  Microsoft SQL Server	 MOL – Prod + Int 8 x DL360 8 x 3par  CHP – Prod + Int 2 x DL360 2 x Primera  Atex – Prod 2 x DL380 2 x Primera	3x  Microsoft SQL Server		
Sydney		29 x Linux 	3 x Windows 		4x  	2x 									

3038 Assets

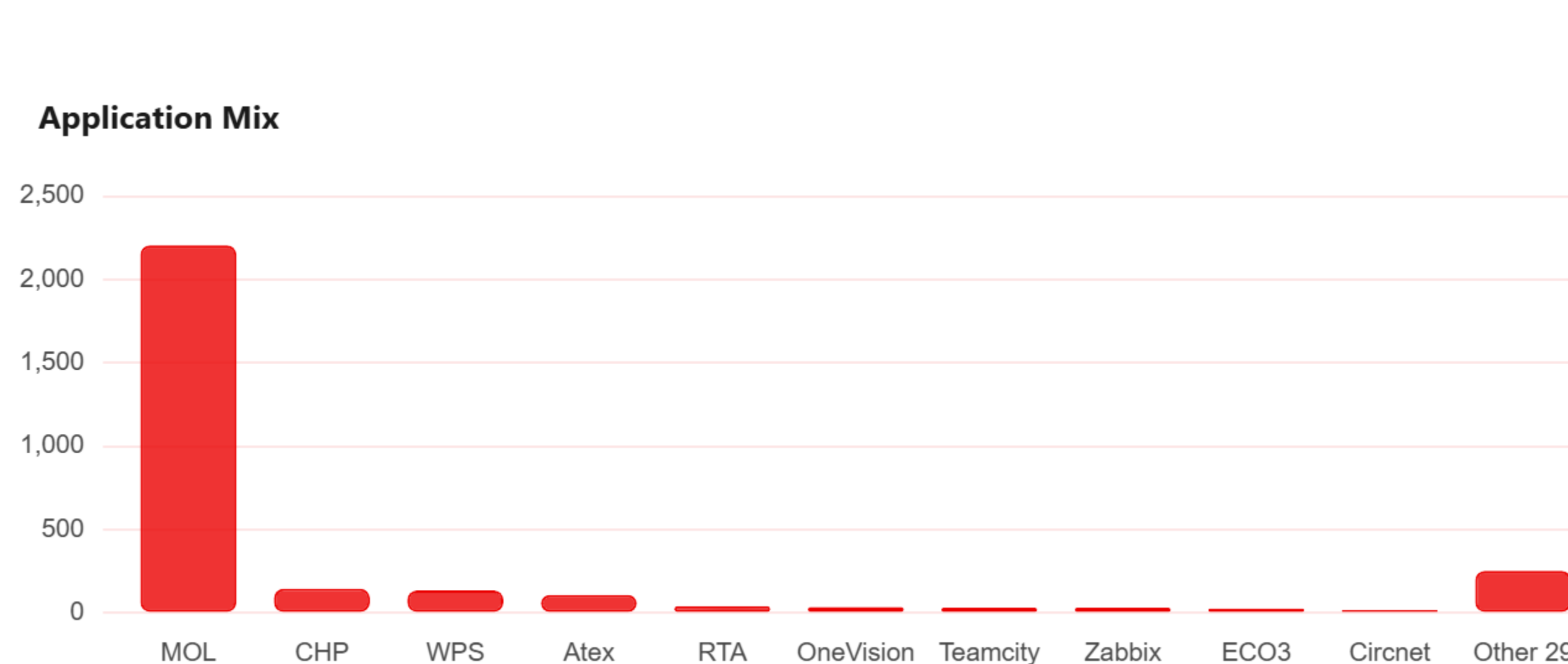
Application landscape

Top 5

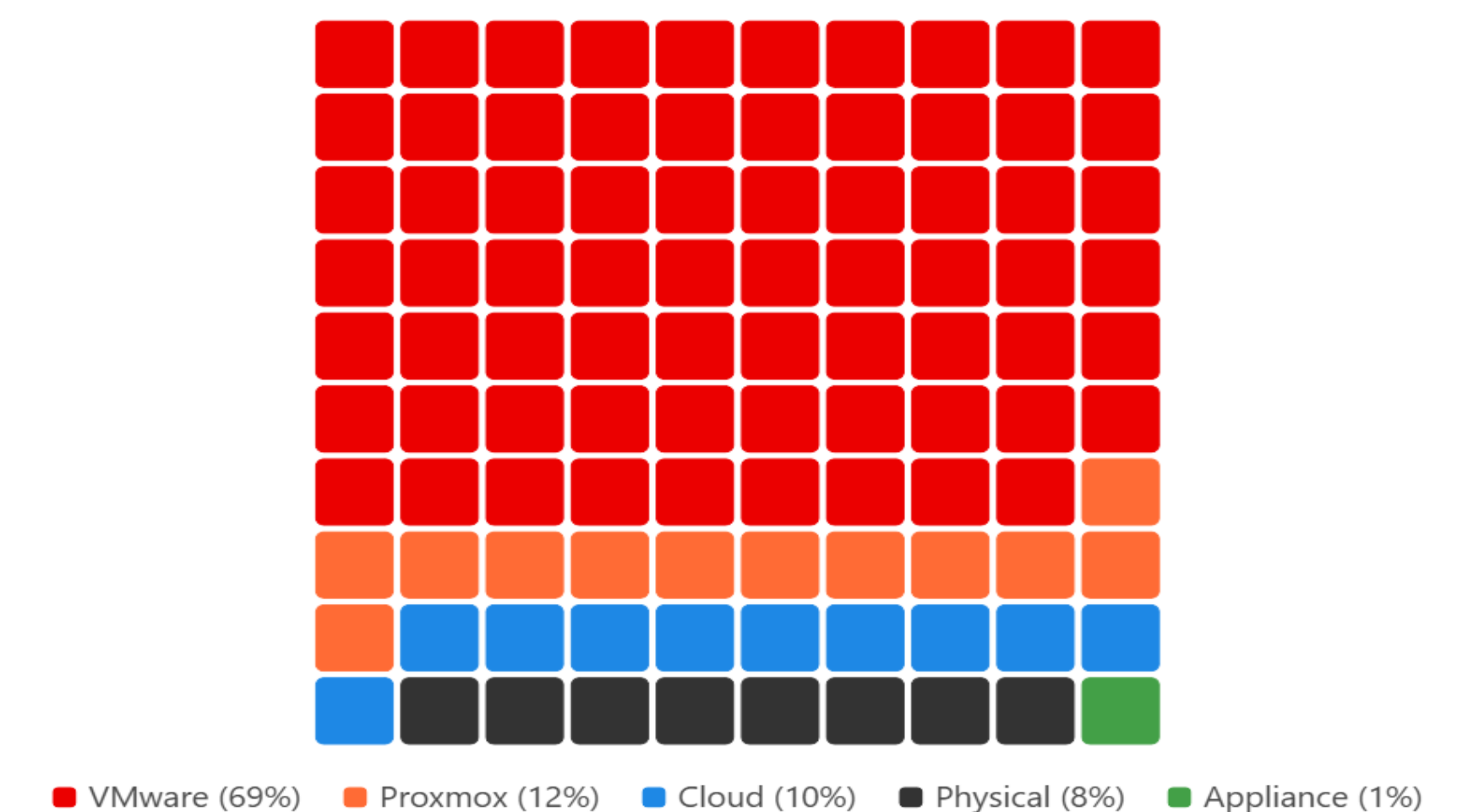
1. **Mail Online:** 2,206 servers (72.6%) 91 sub-components | Oracle at the centre | Dual ownership (CPO + CTO)
2. **CHP:** 146 servers (4.8%) Oracle-backed, publishing operations
3. **WPS:** 136 servers (4.5%) Tightly coupled to Mail Online, must co-migrate
4. **Atex:** 109 servers (3.6%) Multicast constraint, business decision required
5. **RTA:** 41 servers (1.3%) Significantly overprovisioned

Remaining 33 Applications

- 400 servers combined (13%) Editorial tooling, shared services, retirement candidates



Infrastructure Mix



Application Profiling Workshop findings

- **Mail Online is a distributed monolith:** Many sub-services, many dependencies, not independently releasable
- **Oracle is the centre of gravity:** MOL, Atex, CHP, Circnet all depend on Oracle
- **Architectural Constraints:** Atex - hard multicast constraint. Only AWS Transit Gateway can natively support this
- **Sydney is independent:** 38 virtual servers, flexible contract, natural early candidate
- **Retirement candidates** surfaced naturally in discussion with app owners
- **CMDB** is a strong asset for dmz showing current state inventory
- **Application owners** have good knowledge of their technical footprint, dependencies, and lifecycle status
 - **RPO/RTO/Business Criticality/HA/DR** is not clearly understood or necessarily linked to business criticality
 - **Backup** schedules and restore processes are not well understood by the business
- **AWS** knowledge already exists within some business teams, already using CI/CD pipelines and automation
- **Tightly coupled infrastructure-dependant applications** are the norm across the estate
 - **WPS and Mail Online:** Sustained Oracle connections to the B-cluster. Can't be separated. must co-migrate
 - **ECO3 and OneVision** also coupled. OneVision reads from ECO3's courier database via SMB
 - + many other examples

Operating System Lifecycle Position

Over 60% of the estate is past end of standard vendor support. Security patches for these servers are either unavailable or require paid extended support contracts.

Breakdown by OS family:

Ubuntu (85% of estate, 2,587 servers)

- 14.04: 1,114 servers, standard support ended April 2019. Patches only available through paid Ubuntu Pro subscription (ESM). Without it, no patches since 2019.
- 16.04: 603 servers, standard support ended April 2021. Patches only available through paid Ubuntu Pro subscription (ESM). Without it, no patches since 2021.
- 18.04: 75 servers, standard support ended May 2023. ESM available through Ubuntu Pro to 2028.
- 20.04+: 575 servers, supported
- Unknown version: 220 servers

RHEL (5% of estate, 158 servers)

- RHEL 6: 141 servers, maintenance support ended November 2020. Paid ELS add-on ended June 2024. No patches available under any contract.
- RHEL 5: 10 servers, all support including paid ELS ended November 2020. No patches available.
- RHEL 4: 1 server (32-bit), all support ended March 2017. No patches available. Cannot migrate to any cloud platform natively.
- RHEL 7: 6 servers, supported to June 2026

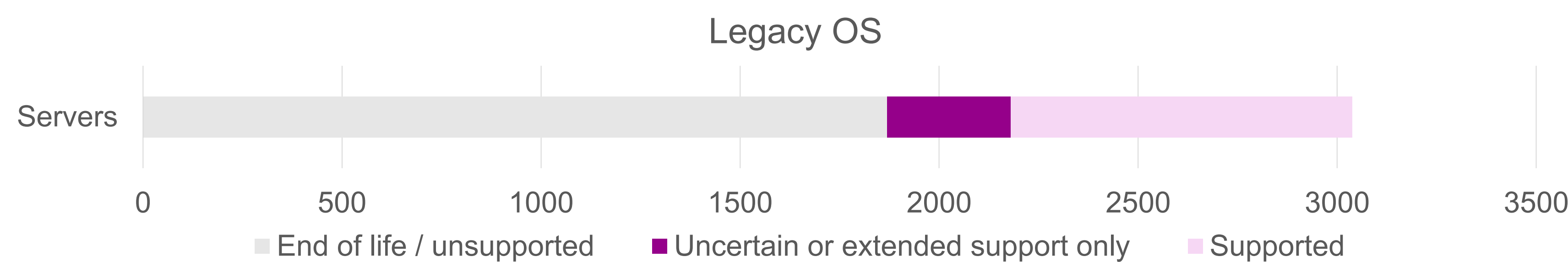
Windows (8% of estate, 234 servers)

- All on Server 2019 or 2022, all supported

Oracle Linux (42 servers): 41 supported, 1 end of life

- Solaris 10 (15 servers): Premier Support ended 2018, Extended Support active to January 2027

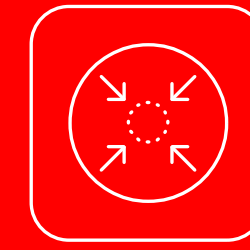
This is a risk that exists today regardless of cloud decision. Migration provides the opportunity to remediate it.



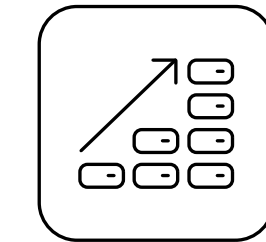
DMG Business Drivers

Cloud Migration Business Drivers - Summary

1. Standardisation + Simplification



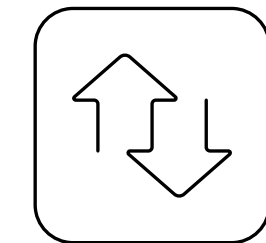
- Reduce complexity to scale operations and delivery speed



2. Productivity + Cost Optimisation



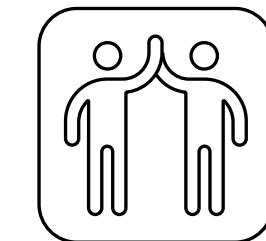
- Remove low value work and create credible savings



3. Automation + Workflow Optimisation



- Reduce toil and improve customer experience



NB: Enhanced Security & Data/AI analytical insights are an expected outcome of transformation, not necessarily a pure business driver.

Driver # 1

Standardisation + Simplification

Simplification is the foundation for predictable, scalable growth.

Goal

- Meet North Star growth targets across all brands
 - Eg MOL – 1M Subscribers
- Alignment of Core Technology products across DMG Business
- Eliminate Shadow IT

Strategic Intent

- Standardisation is a prerequisite for scalable growth
- Platform sprawl increases cost, risk, and execution friction
- Converge on a limited set of approved platforms and architectural patterns
- Enforce security, compliance, and governance by design
- Preserve innovation while eliminating unnecessary variation

Outcome

- Simplified Target Operating Model (TOM)
- Lower execution and operational risk
- Faster, more predictable delivery of change
- A scalable foundation that supports growth without proportional complexity
- DMG aspiration for engineering to be self-sufficient within predefined infrastructure guardrails

Driver # 2

Productivity + Cost Optimisation

Cloud shifts cost from fixed overhead to optimised, value-driven consumption

Goal

- Reduce total cost of ownership while improving delivery velocity
- Replacement with pre-approved blueprints/templates
- Removal of custom systems and processes providing low value
- Shift from fixed, capacity-based cost models to demand-aligned consumption

Strategic Intent

- Translate cloud adoption into financial performance
- Cloud only delivers value with active cost discipline
- Inefficiency compounds rapidly at scale
- Embed financial accountability into technology decision-making

Outcome

- Measurable cost optimisation and improved margin predictability
- Clear visibility of spend by platform, product, and environment
- Financial governance (FinOps) embedded into the operating model

Driver # 3

Automation + Workflow Optimisation

Automation is not just efficiency. This is the foundation for DMG to scaling innovation and competing at digital speed.

Goal

- Replace manual processes with automated, repeatable workflows.
- Enable self-service platforms for development and editorial teams
- Embed automation into infrastructure, deployment and on-going operations.
- Shift from reactive operations to real-time and event-driven operations.

Strategic intent

- Increased velocity: Manual processes limit growth and degrade customer experience
- Scalable innovation: Automation is essential for enterprise-scale cloud operations, shorten development lifecycle and business enablement
- Reduced risk and increased consistency Improve service performance and resilience.
- Default to cloud-native and managed services where appropriate

Outcome

- Teams focused on innovation and growth - not keeping the lights on
- Reduced operational and key-person risk
- Ability to scale revenue without linear cost growth
- Business teams focused on value creation rather than administration
- Removes manual configuration errors
- Automation makes the whole estate reproducible and auditable

Hyperscaler Weighted Scoring Assessment

Hyperscaler Weighted Scoring

Weighted scoring confirms
AWS as the platform best
aligned to reduce risk,
control cost, and deliver at
pace.

		aws					
				GCP		Azure	
Strategic Goal	DMG Priority	AWS		GCP		Azure	
Uptime	High	4.2	84%	4.2	84%	4.2	84%
Reliability	Moderate	4.8	96%	4.4	88%	4.6	92%
Scalability	Moderate	4.8	96%	4.8	96%	4.5	90%
Security	Moderate	4.3	86%	4.6	92%	4.8	96%
Performance	High	4.7	94%	4.3	86%	4.3	86%
Business Analytics	Moderate	4.3	86%	4.5	90%	4.2	84%
Transparency	Moderate	4.0	80%	4.2	84%	4.0	80%
Cost	Very High	4.7	94%	4.2	84%	3.8	76%
Sovereignty	Moderate	3.7	74%	3.4	68%	3.7	74%
Business Fit	Very High	4.5	90%	4.1	82%	4.3	86%
Sustainability	Low	3.3	66%	5.0	100%	4.0	80%
Licensing	High	3.5	70%	3.3	66%	4.3	86%
Velocity	High	4.7	94%	4.6	92%	4.6	92%
Overall Score		912.0	88%	884.0	85%	880.0	85%
Placing		1st		2nd		3rd	

Weighted Scoring – DMG Key Value Dials

Across 59 scored criteria,
AWS leads where the
weighting is highest: cost
predictability, migration
readiness, day 0/1/2
operations, and AI tooling.
The platform that scores
best on what matters most.

Very High & High weighted dials only
shown here.

Strategic Goal	Code	Value Dial	DMG Weighting	AWS Score	GCP Score	Azure Score
Business Fit	FIT-10	Database Migration Path	Very High	20.0	25.0	15.0
	FIT-3	3rd Party Integration	High	20.0	20.0	20.0
	FIT-5	Partner & Talent Availability	High	20.0	12.0	16.0
	FIT-6	Executive Relationship & Strategic Alignment	Very High	20.0	20.0	20.0
	FIT-8	Day 0,1,2 Operations	Very High	25.0	20.0	25.0
	FIT-9	Target Operating Model	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
Cost	CST-1	TCO	Very High	25.0	25.0	15.0
	CST-2	Predictability vs Elasticity	Very High	25.0	25.0	20.0
	CST-3	Egress Sensitivity	Very High	15.0	15.0	15.0
	CST-4	Discount Programs	Very High	25.0	20.0	20.0
	CST-5	Migration Costs	Very High	25.0	20.0	20.0
	CST-6	FinOps Tooling	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
Licensing	LIC-1	BYOL Flexibility	High	12.0	12.0	20.0
	LIC-2	Hybrid Licensing Benefits	Very High	15.0	15.0	20.0
Performance	PERF-1	Latency Sensitivity	High	20.0	16.0	16.0
	PERF-3	Storage Throughput	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
	PERF-4	Network Backbone Quality	High	16.0	20.0	16.0
Reliability	REL-1	Data Durability	High	20.0	20.0	20.0
	REL-2	Backup and Recovery	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
Scalability	SCL-3	Data Scale Growth Curve	High	20.0	20.0	20.0
Security	SEC-1	Regulatory Compliance Alignment	Very High	25.0	25.0	25.0
	SEC-2	Identity & Access Maturity	High	16.0	16.0	20.0
	SEC-4	Threat Detection & SOC Integration	High	16.0	20.0	20.0
Sovereignty	SOV-1	Data Residency Requirements	High	16.0	16.0	16.0
Transparency	TRN-2	Incident Reporting Detail	High	16.0	16.0	16.0
	TRN-3	Billing Granularity	High	16.0	20.0	16.0
Uptime	UPT-3	Multi-Region Resilience	Very High	20.0	20.0	20.0
	UPT-4	Planned Maintenance Transparency	High	16.0	16.0	16.0
	UPT-5	Dependency Resilience	High	16.0	16.0	16.0
Velocity	VEL-1	DevOps Toolchain Integration	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
	VEL-2	Infrastructure as Code Maturity	High	20.0	16.0	20.0
	VEL-3	Managed Service Abstraction	High	16.0	20.0	16.0
	VEL-4	Time-to-Prototype	High	16.0	20.0	16.0
	VEL-5	AI Tooling Integration	High	25.0	25.0	25.0
	VEL-6	Container & Kubernetes Maturity	High	20.0	20.0	16.0
Total:				912.0	884.0	880.0
Placing:				1	2	3

Business and Application Fit

AWS is the best business fit for DMG next phases of growth...

- **Delivers enterprise scale without locking in future cost**
→ *Outcome:* AWS is cost-competitive at baseline and provides the levers to continuously optimize and reduce cost over time, supported by mature FinOps capabilities. The levers include savings plans, instance right-sizing and instant optimization (eg, Graviton for managed databases), service substitution and storage tiering.
- **Builds on DMG's existing AWS footprint to accelerate time to value**
→ *Outcome:* AWS accelerates time to value through building on existing DMG workflows, connectivity in place, and existing expertise. This will result in faster migration, lower execution risk, and immediate productivity gains by leveraging existing skills, tooling, and deployed workloads (e.g. video streaming)
- **Aligns to DMG's technical reality, avoiding costly rework**
→ *Outcome:* AWS aligns most closely to DMG's current architecture, supporting key requirements such as multicast natively and reducing the need for application refactoring in the first phase. This will minimise transformation risk, cost, and delivery timelines across the estate.
- **Best aligned to DMG's operating model and delivery approach**
→ *Outcome:* AWS enables a scalable, partner-assisted operating model through the largest ecosystem of certified partners, services, and skilled resources. This reduces dependency on scarce internal capabilities and accelerating delivery at scale.
- **Supports media-scale performance and global demand patterns**
→ *Outcome:* AWS provides proven global infrastructure, high-performance compute options, and elastic scaling capabilities to support high-volume publishing, real-time traffic spikes, and global audience delivery across DMG's digital platforms
- **Enables standardisation and simplification across the estate**
→ *Outcome:* AWS provides a comprehensive data and AI ecosystem that supports real-time data processing, AI-driven personalisation, and experimentation — enabling DMG to scale subscriber growth and continuously optimise digital experiences
- **Unlocks data, AI, and subscriber growth at scale**
→ *Outcome:* Foundation for real-time data platforms, AI-driven personalisation, and experimentation, directly supporting the 1 million subscriber ambition
- **Embeds AI and automation across the entire operating model**
→ *Outcome:* AWS embeds AI and automation directly into applications, infrastructure, and workflows through services such as Bedrock, SageMaker, and event-driven architectures — enabling real-time decisioning, workflow optimisation, and scalable operational efficiency.

AI Compatibility Comparison - AWS vs GCP vs Azure (2026)

Capability Area	AWS	GCP	Azure
Core AI Platform	SageMaker + Bedrock (modular toolkit), Kiro IDE	Vertex AI (unified platform), Antigravity	Azure AI / ML + OpenAI
AI Philosophy	Builder-first, flexible ecosystem	Data-first, integrated ML platform	Enterprise-first, integrated with Microsoft stack
Generative AI Models	Amazon Nova + Broad marketplace (Claude, Llama, Titan, Mistral)	Native models (Gemini, Imagen) + OSS	OpenAI (GPT family) + OSS
Data + AI Integration	Strong, requires orchestration across services	Integration with BigQuery (native data → AI pipeline)	Strong with Microsoft Fabric / Synapse
MLOps & Lifecycle	Highly flexible, modular pipelines (CI/CD driven)	Streamlined, unified lifecycle	Strong enterprise tooling + UI-driven workflows
Ease of Use	Highly flexible, requires engineering maturity	Most opinionated around approaches for ML teams	Balanced (GUI + code)
Scale & Infrastructure	Broadest GPU + custom chips (Trainium, Inferentia)	TPU advantage for large-scale ML workloads	Strong GPU + enterprise infra
AI in Applications	Strong integration into apps, services, and workflows	Strong in data/analytics-driven AI use cases	Strong in enterprise productivity (Copilot, M365)
Best Fit	Operational AI at scale across applications	Data-centric AI, analytics, ML-heavy workloads	Enterprise AI + Microsoft ecosystem

AWS delivers AI at scale across the full operating model and embeds AI into your applications and operations.

GCP focused on data-driven AI, Azure at enterprise integration (Eg, modern workplace).

Cost Comparison

Understanding the on-premise baseline costs

OS/DB License costs carried into Cloud – offset with BYOL discount		Services costs carried into cloud in 'lift & shift' – eliminate by transformation		Replaced by cloud consumption costs			
				Included in Baseline	Missing from Baseline - CRITICAL		
Windows Server (£137K) — existing licences, SA assumed. Enables BYOL to avoid cloud surcharge. EA expires May 2027. SQL Server (£119K) — existing licences, SA assumed. 33 instances, 132 cores. SA status to be confirmed with Bluesource. Linux / RHEL / SUSE (£71K) — annual subscriptions. Enables BYOL via Red Hat Cloud Access. Subtotal: £ 326,793		Database management (£568K) — Reducible as managed Platform DB services replace manual support Tenable / Guardicore (£444K) — Server portion replaceable with cloud-native security. Oracle support (£650K) — Potential to eliminate by replatforming to PostgreSQL (multi-year project) Ubuntu patching (£20K) — Replaceable with cloud-native patch management Microsoft support (£80K) —Tied to EA and SQL support. Reducible if Microsoft footprint decreases post-Workspace decision. Subtotal: £ 1,761,888		Hardware and storage (£548K) Server purchase/lease, SAN/NAS, backup, maintenance Colocation (£765K) Reading, Slough, Sydney facility costs Networking (£115K) Interconnect and internet egress Operations (£120K) Infrastructure staff and vendor support Subtotal: £ 1,547,661		Broadcom VCF (cost TBC) Perpetual VMWare licenses exclude support. No patches, no support, no new hosts without it Hardware (cost TBC) Refresh line is blank, Unretrievable Invoices, depreciation not fully amortised Security exposure (cost TBC) 1,870 servers past end of standard support, expired VMware SnS Subtotal: £ TBC	

Baseline Cost: £3,636,342
Excludes right hand (missing items). True on-prem cost is higher

How Rackspace built the cloud cost view

3,038 servers | 14,165 vCPUs |
53,758 GB memory | 1.26 PB
storage

- **DMG Media discovery data is the single source.** Server inventory, CPU, memory, storage, and OS collected from VMware, Proxmox, and physical environments across Reading, Slough, and Sydney. 3,038 servers across 5 infrastructure types.
- **Normalised into one consistent dataset.** Different infrastructure types report data differently. Custom automation built to normalise VMware, Proxmox, physical, appliance, and existing cloud inventory into a single format so every server is described the same way regardless of where it sits.
- **One dataset fed to all three clouds.** Each cloud's own sizing tool ingested the same normalised input. GCP Migration Center, AWS Transform, Azure Migrate. No cloud received a different version of the estate.
- **Each tool applies its own rightsizing.** The source data is provisioned spec (what the VMs are allocated today). Each tool recommends cloud instances based on its own rightsizing algorithm: GCP at 32% of source vCPU, AWS at 49%, Azure at 53% with a 2-vCPU minimum. More aggressive rightsizing produces a lower cost. Actual utilisation data (limited by 1,227 servers without VMware Tools) would refine these assumptions in Part 2.
- **Priced at both pay-as-you-go and 3-year committed.** Pay-as-you-go is the starting rate with no commitment. 3-year committed pricing delivers 35-42% savings depending on platform. The cost comparison uses 3-year committed because that reflects the post-migration operating model once workloads are established in cloud.
- **The comparison is built in layers.** Cloud infrastructure first, then Oracle Exadata@Cloud, then operational costs carried forward from on-prem. The complete view combines all three against the £3.6M baseline (which excludes Broadcom VCF, hardware refresh, and security exposure).
- **Every SKU re-priced against live APIs.** AWS Price List API, GCP Billing Catalog API, Azure Retail Prices API. This removes tool-specific pricing bias and provides a verifiable, reproducible number.
- **Oracle modelled separately.** Three distinct paths with different mechanics per cloud. Exadata@Cloud used consistently across all three for comparability.
- **Credits & provider pricings excluded from this baseline.** The hyperscalers' own pricing and credit offerings are covered separately.

Cloud infrastructure cost: Pay as you go (PayG) vs 3-year committed

- **Two pricing models.** Pay-as-you-go is the starting rate with no commitment, full flexibility. 3-year committed locks in capacity at 35-42% lower cost. The comparison to on-prem uses 3-year committed because that reflects the post-migration operating model.
- **London region shown.** All three clouds were priced across multiple regions (London, Ireland/Frankfurt). London is used for the comparison because it matches DMG Media's current datacentre locations and data residency requirements. Alternative region pricing is available in the appendix. GCP can only run Exadata in London.
- **AWS and GCP within 2% on 3-year committed.** The cost difference between these two platforms is not a differentiator at this level. Azure is 45% higher, driven by storage pricing and VM sizing constraints.
- **Why the numbers differ between clouds.** Each tool right-sizes differently: GCP to 32% of source vCPU, AWS to 49%, Azure to 53%. Azure storage variance is driven by SSD class at 80,000 IOPS matched. Part 2 utilisation data will validate which sizing assumption is closest to reality.
- **This is cloud infrastructure only.** Compute, storage, OS licensing, and network. Oracle, carried-forward operational costs, and credits are added in the following slides.

Pay as you go Pricing Breakdown (Annual)			
London			
	 AWS	 GCP	 Azure
Compute	£2,746,884	£2,352,300	£2,740,920
Storage	£763,044	£1,092,060	£1,913,352
OS License	£253,260	£118,596	£210,984
Network (5%)	£175,500	£172,212	£232,716
Total:	£3,938,677	£3,735,172	£5,097,970

3yr Commitment Pricing Summary (Annualised)			
London			
	AWS	GCP	Azure
Annual	£2,283,419	£2,243,685	£3,298,566
Savings vs Pay as you go (%)	42%	40%	35%

Complete cost comparison: cloud vs on-prem

What this comparison shows

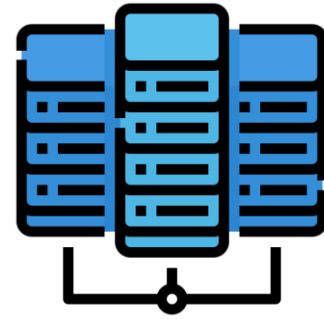
- **Yes, cloud costs more on these numbers.** This is expected. Here is why, and why it changes.
- **Cloud replaces £1.5M of on-prem cost but the infrastructure appears more expensive.** The on-prem infrastructure figure (hardware, storage, VMware) is understated: VMware licensing at £0, hardware refresh blank, depreciation not fully amortised. The gap is partly real, partly a baseline problem.
- **£1,762K of today's operational costs carry forward unchanged.** This is the largest lever available. As managed services, cloud-native security, and replatforming take effect, this number comes down.
- **The on-prem baseline (£3.6M) is incomplete.** Broadcom VCF, hardware refresh, and security exposure are not included. The real gap is narrower than the differential shows.
- **Hyperscaler credits and discounts are not yet applied.** These are covered in the following slides and reduce the cloud figure further.
- **The business case is built through transformation, not migration.** Lift-and-shift establishes the platform. The cost advantage follows. Part 2 of the CRA starts to map that out.

Cost (annual)	AWS	GCP	Azure
Cloud Consumption Costs			
			
Cloud infrastructure (3yr committed: compute, storage, OS, network)	£2,283,419	£2,243,685	£3,298,566
Oracle Exadata@Cloud	£514,908	£514,908	£514,908
Hyperscaler support (Enterprise)	£200,609	£224,369	£271,670
Internet egress (illustrative, 100TB/mo)	£70,668	£75,288	£57,984
Services costs carried into cloud in 'lift & shift' – eliminate by transformation			
DB management, security tooling, Oracle support, Ubuntu patching, MS support	£1,761,888	£1,761,888	£1,761,888
OS/DB License costs carried into Cloud – offset with BYOL discount			
Licensing (Windows, SQL, RHEL)	£326,793	£326,793	£326,793
BYOL discount applied	-£339,492	-£329,268	-£441,000
Additional Optimisation			
Storage tiering (non-prod to HDD)	-£123,132	-£223,236	-£119,568
Lift & Shift Cloud Consumption Cost (Pre-Transformation)	£4,695,661	£4,594,427	£5,671,241
On-Prem costs – excluding some critical items around Broadcom VCF, some hardware and security exposure.	£3,636,342	£3,636,342	£3,636,342
Current Differential	£1,059,319	£958,085	£2,034,899

Balancing the cost equation

On-prem = fixed and rising costs

Cloud = variable and optimisable costs



Fixed Cost Model

- CapEx lock-in (3-5 years)
- Cost incurred regardless of usage

Capacity Planning

- Over-provisioned for peak demand

Rising Cost Base

- Server prices set to increase around 15%*
- * **VMware licensing costs increasing significantly at renewal**
 - Shift to subscription-only model
 - Bundled licensing and minimum commitments
 - Re-entry after expiry can result in substantial cost increases
 - Customer-reported increases 500%+ ^

Incomplete cost visibility

- Some costs data unavailable or not captured
- True DC cost position likely understated

OpEx Pay as your go model

- Cost aligned to consumption

Elastic Scaling

- Not paying for unused capacity. Cost savings through turning lower environments (eg, DEV) overnight. Autoscaling presentation layer capacity

Cloud Cost Reducers

- Hyperscaler discounts + credits
- Replatforming for PaaS over IaaS
- Reserved capacity / saving plans
- CDN / edge optimization
- Platform services (PaaS efficiencies)

Operational Levers:

- Storage tiering (eg, backups and long-term storage)
- FinOps cost optimizations (right-sizing, more cost-effective architectures, scheduling).

Full cost visibility

- Real-time usage and cost tracking

Hyperscaler Offerings - snapshot

Why this is here? Rackspace engaged all three hyperscalers on DMG Media's behalf. These are their figures.

Our independent pricing is the consistent baseline. Scope, sizing, and commitment models differ between providers. Headlines are not directly comparable.

Key points

- GCP bundles database and security costs. AWS and Azure do not.
- Commitment models differ: AWS full RI, GCP 3-year CUD, Azure 30/70 PAYG/RI blend.
- A lower headline does not mean a cheaper outcome. The detail matters more than the total.

For the hyperscaler sessions consider key questions:

- How did you size the workloads?
- What is the full Oracle path?
- What is the commercial offer: pricing, credits, funded resources?
- What is not included?
- What does BYOL look like for Server 2022?

Watch for

- Cost figures missing Oracle, SQL licensing, or support
- Year 1 savings claims ignoring dual-run cost
- Sizing with no independent validation



	<u>London OD</u>	<u>London RI Full</u>	<u>Ireland OD</u>	<u>Ireland RI Full</u>	<u>Frankfurt OD</u>	<u>Frankfurt RI Full</u>
Compute (monthly)	268,563	137,149	250,768	129,225	277,894	131,233
EBS Storage (monthly)	60,860	60,860	57,712	57,712	62,434	62,434
TOTAL (monthly)	329,423	198,009	308,480	186,937	340,328	193,667
TOTAL (annual)	3,953,080	<u>2,376,112</u>	3,701,762	<u>2,243,242</u>	4,083,940	<u>2,324,003</u>
RI Full Discount vs OD		39.89%		39.40%		43.09%



	LONDON			FRANKFURT			BELGIUM		
Type	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y1	Y2	Y3	Y1	Y2	Y3
Cloud - Compute Engine - London - 3 Year CUD - VMWare Source (93%)	\$2,833,817.49	\$2,833,817.49	\$2,833,817.49	\$2,888,404.97	\$2,888,404.97	\$2,888,404.97	\$2,521,479.24	\$2,521,479.24	\$2,521,479.24
Cloud - Compute Engine - London - 3 Year CUD - Microsoft Source (7%)	\$213,298.09	\$213,298.09	\$213,298.09	\$217,406.83	\$217,406.83	\$217,406.83	\$189,788.76	\$189,788.76	\$189,788.76
Databases - SQL	\$707,960.85	\$707,960.85	\$707,960.85	\$707,960.85	\$707,960.85	\$707,960.85	\$643,589.10	\$643,589.10	\$643,589.10
Databases - Oracle	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80	\$1,094,725.80
Security & Networking	\$261,253.82	\$267,448.82	\$274,263.32	\$264,188.63	\$270,383.63	\$277,198.13	\$241,242.86	\$247,437.86	\$254,252.36
	\$5,111,056.05	\$5,117,251.05	\$5,124,065.55	\$5,172,687.08	\$5,178,882.08	\$5,185,696.58	\$4,690,825.76	\$4,697,020.76	\$4,703,835.26
	\$15,352,372.66			\$15,537,265.74			\$14,091,681.78		



Option B (30% PAYG + 70% RIs)		
Region	Monthly	Annually
UK South	\$ 218,999.63	\$ 2,627,995.60
North Europe	\$ 199,654.84	\$ 2,395,858.05
Germany West Central	\$ 206,053.05	\$ 2,472,636.57

Hyperscaler Offerings - Funding Summary

What are hyperscaler credits?

Cloud providers offer credits as part of large migration commitments. These are not discounts on list price. They are cash credits applied to the cloud bill, typically over the first 1-3 years, to offset the cost of running two environments during migration (dual-run).

Why do they offer them?

Credits are an investment by the provider to win long-term consumption. The provider funds the transition because the 3-year committed spend that follows is worth significantly more than the credit. The larger the committed workload, the larger the credit available.

How do they work?

Credits are tied to consumption targets. DMG Media commits to a level of cloud spend over an agreed period. The provider releases credits against that commitment. If consumption falls below the target, credits may not fully materialise. ***These figures are indicative, based on established funding programmes, and subject to formal approval.**

What else is available?

Beyond credits, hyperscaler partner programmes also fund migration and modernisation activities: assessment, planning, migration execution, and skills enablement. This is separate from the credits shown here and will be addressed as part of the commercial discussions.

Azure position is TBC

Azure numbers were not available at time of publication. To be confirmed in the mid-May hyperscaler session.



Details	AWS	GCP	Azure
Total cloud spend (3-yrs committed annual)	\$ 3,024,396	\$ 2,243,685	\$ 4,368,962
Total Cloud Consumption Credits:	\$ 756,099*	\$ 745,192*	Azure Numbers TBC
Total funding in GBP	£ 570,854*	£ 562,619*	

FX Rate: 1 USD = 0.755 GBP

Overall Hyperscaler Recommendation

Rackspace Overall Recommendation

AWS transforms your business with the least disruption, lowest risk, and fastest path to value.

ID	Category (Top = Most Important)	 (1st)	 (2nd)	 (3rd)
1	Application & Technical Fit	Best fit overall – handles widest range of workloads with minimal refactoring	Good fit but gaps (e.g. multicast)	More constraints, especially around legacy + infra patterns
1.1	App-specific constraints (Atex, multicast)	Only platform supporting multicast natively → no refactor required	Requires refactor to unicast (cost + risk)	Same limitation as GCP
1.2	Architecture flexibility	Broadest support for infra-heavy, tightly coupled apps	Strong but less flexible for legacy patterns	More rigid (VM sizing, storage, tooling limits)
2	Business Fit & Operating Model	Strongest alignment with DMG operating model (partner-led, hybrid skills)	Limited enterprise alignment vs AWS	Strong Microsoft ecosystem but less relevant to Linux-heavy estate
2.1	Existing estate alignment	Video streaming already on AWS, internal teams have AWS skills	Analytics already on GCP (valid exception)	Limited workload alignment
3	Ecosystem & Skills Availability	Largest ecosystem + partner market (esp. media)	Growing but smaller ecosystem	Strong in Microsoft-centric orgs
4	Platform & Team Readiness Synergy	Existing Direct Connect + internal AWS familiarity	Analytics teams aligned to GCP	Microsoft tooling familiarity (limited impact due to low Windows %)
5	Application Synergies	Video streaming + infra workloads aligned	Best for analytics (BigQuery) → stays	365 / Entra / Sentinel add value but not core to estate
6	Performance, Reliability, Scale	Leads in performance + reliability categories	Strong scalability	Competitive but not leading
7	Partner Ecosystem & Marketplace	Largest + most mature marketplace	Smaller ecosystem	Enterprise partner base (Microsoft-centric)
8	Connectivity & Hybrid Readiness	Direct Connect already configured	Standard connectivity	Standard VPN / ExpressRoute
9	AI & Data Platform	Bedrock + SageMaker (broad platform play)	Best-in-class analytics (BigQuery, Vertex AI)	Azure AI strong but less aligned to use cases
10	Internal/Strategic Alignment	Strong infra + app alignment	Analytics retained	Security & identity strengths only
11	Cost (3-Year TCO – Complete View)	£4.60M/year (~2% above GCP)	£4.51M/year (cheapest)	£5.59M/year (~24% higher)
11.1	Cost Drivers	Balanced sizing, competitive storage	Aggressive rightsizing (32% vCPU)	Premium storage + less efficient sizing
12	Discounts & Commercials	Strongest funding + credits potential (MAP, EDP)	Competitive but lower funding scale	Unclear / weaker position
13	Licensing & Credits	BYOL works but with constraints	BYOL more complex (Sole Tenant)	Best (AHB) but limited impact (only ~7.7% Windows estate)
14	Market / External Factors	Strong market maturity	Neutral	Capacity concerns (UK South)
15	Strategic Differentiators	Balanced across all decision pillars	Analytics niche leader	Security + Microsoft ecosystem
16	Workplace & Collaboration Alignment	Neutral impact, decoupled from infra decision	Strengthens position if Google Workspace adopted	Weakened if moving away from M365 ecosystem

Multi-cloud Model: Preferred Cloud + Secondary Cloud

Single cloud vs multi-cloud

- Single cloud means one platform for everything. Simpler to operate, one set of skills, one commercial relationship.
- Multi-cloud means a primary platform for the majority of workloads, with a secondary platform retained where it provides specific value.

Why multi-cloud fits for DMG Media.

- Based on what DMG Media has shared during this assessment, a single-cloud approach does not reflect the reality of the estate. Analytics is already embedded in GCP (BigQuery). Video streaming is already on AWS.
- The Workspace decision, if it proceeds, brings GCP into collaboration and further 3rd party tooling for identity. These are existing commitments and strategic directions, not infrastructure choices.

What this assessment recommends

- AWS as the primary platform for the assessed estate: core applications, Atex, general compute, and modernisation.
- GCP retained for analytics where BigQuery is already embedded.
- The remaining workload placements in the table (AI, Workspace, security, CDN) depend on decisions outside this assessment and are shown as illustrative, not assessed.

Trade-offs to manage

- Two platforms means two sets of skills, tooling, and governance
- Identity needs a unified approach if Microsoft tooling is replaced
- Data movement between clouds adds cost and latency

Workload Domain	Best Fit Cloud	Rationale
Assessed in CRA Part 1		
Core Applications (Mail Online, WPS, CHP)	AWS	Handles tightly coupled workloads with minimal refactoring
Atex (Multicast dependency)	AWS	Only platform with native multicast support
General Compute / VM Migration	AWS	Broadest compatibility + least rework
Application Modernisation (Containers, Microservices)	AWS	Mature platform + strong ecosystem
Subject to separate decisions (not assessed in Part 1)		
Video Streaming	AWS	Already running on AWS Elemental
Data Analytics / BI	GCP	Best-in-class (BigQuery)
AI / ML / GenAI	AWS	Best aligned to embedding AI into DMG's applications, content workflows, and customer experience.
Workplace & Collaboration (if Google Workspace adopted)	Assumed GCP	Native integration with Workspace ecosystem
Security / Identity (existing Microsoft stack)	Azure (if M365 retained) / Third Party Services (If Google Workspae Selected)	If M365 is replaced, Entra ID and Sentinel replaced by cloud-agnostic alternatives (e.g. Okta, CrowdStrike). Depends on Workspace decision.
Edge / CDN (future option)	AWS / GCP	Depends on Akamai replacement strategy

AWS is the primary platform for core application delivery and platform operations, with GCP retained for specific domain capabilities, For example, data analytics and associated AI using GCP.

DMG Readiness

How we assessed readiness

Your team has deep expertise in VMware, Oracle, and networking. A low score here reflects the starting point of a cloud journey, not a judgement on current capability.

Choosing the right cloud platform is only half the decision. The other half is whether the organisation is ready to adopt it. A platform recommendation without a readiness assessment leaves you with a destination and no roadmap. This section answers: where are you today, what gaps need closing, and what does Part 2 need to address before migration starts.

We assessed readiness across 24 sub-categories in five dimensions, scored 1 to 5, through application workshops, infrastructure discovery, and stakeholder interviews during the 11-week engagement.

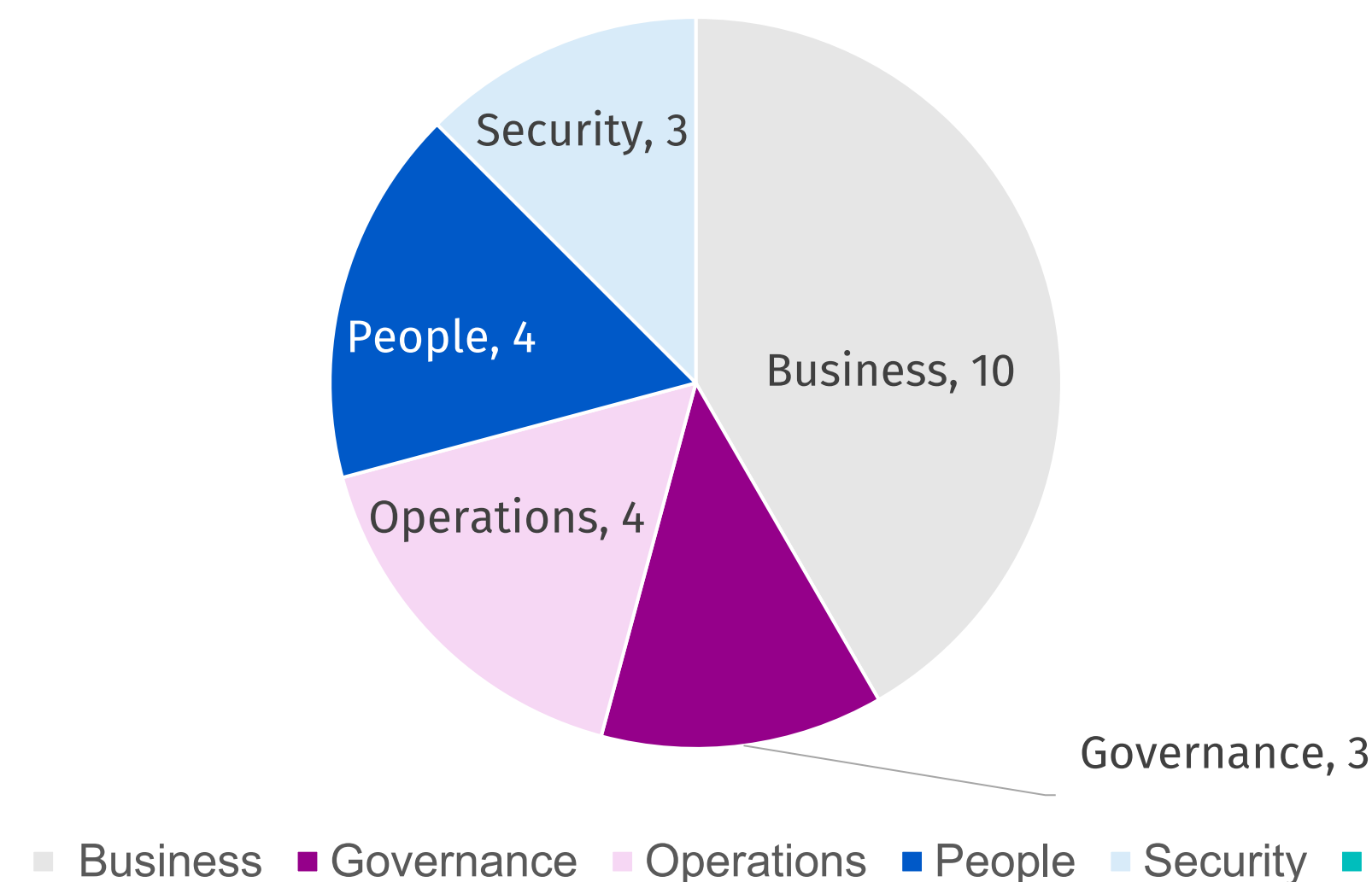
Scale:

- 1 = No cloud capability in place. No planning, no skills, no process.
- 2 = Early awareness. Some informal activity but nothing documented or consistent.
- 3 = Documented approach. Defined but not consistently applied across the organisation.
- 4 = Consistent practice. Actively managed, measured, repeatable.
- 5 = Optimised. Cloud-mature, continuously improving, operating independently.

Dimensions assessed:

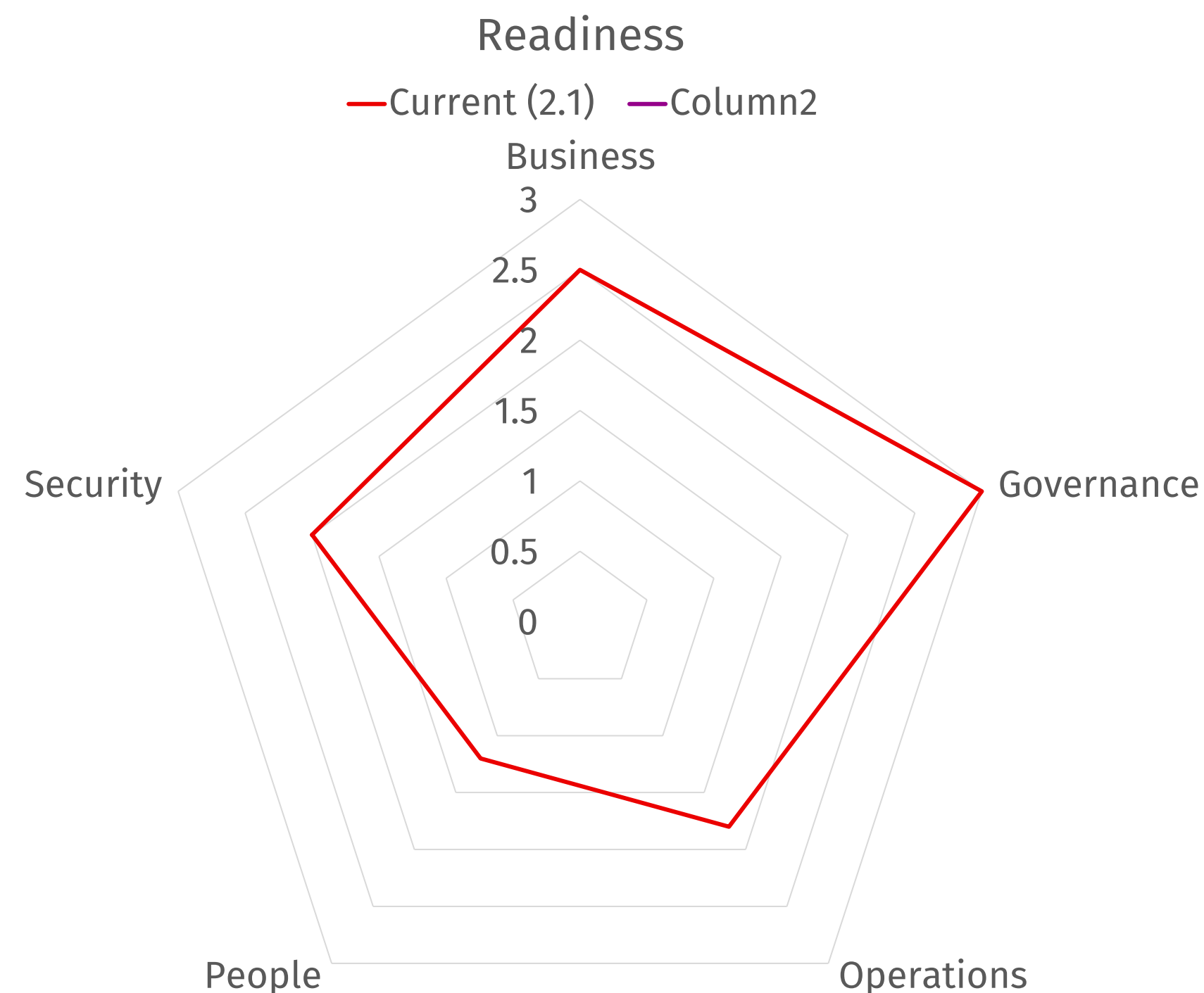
- Business (10 sub-categories): objectives, governance, cloud strategy, supplier management, risk, compliance
- Governance (3): portfolio management, service delivery, programme management
- Operations (4): disaster recovery, operating model, FinOps, cost allocation
- People (4): roles, training, staffing, change management
- Security (3): strategy, GRC, lifecycle capabilities

Dimensions



Readiness today

Cloud-specific, not overall capability



Governance (3.0), strongest area

- CMDB maintained and updated during discovery. App owners mapped. EA practice established. CSP selection process documented through this CRA. This gives you a foundation to build on.

Business (2.5), strategic intent clear, organisational machinery early

- Objectives defined (1M subscribers, standardisation, capex to opex). Supplier relationships exist with all three hyperscalers, AWS most advanced. But cloud strategy, value management, IT strategy, and risk management are all early stage. The CTO is making the case but broad stakeholder buy-in is not yet in place.

Security (2.0), CISO engaged, nothing formalised for cloud

- NIST/CSF used as a guide but not enforced. Shared responsibility model not yet documented. Workspaces decision (M365 to Google Workspace) has implications for identity and security tooling.

Operations (1.8), fragmentation shows up here

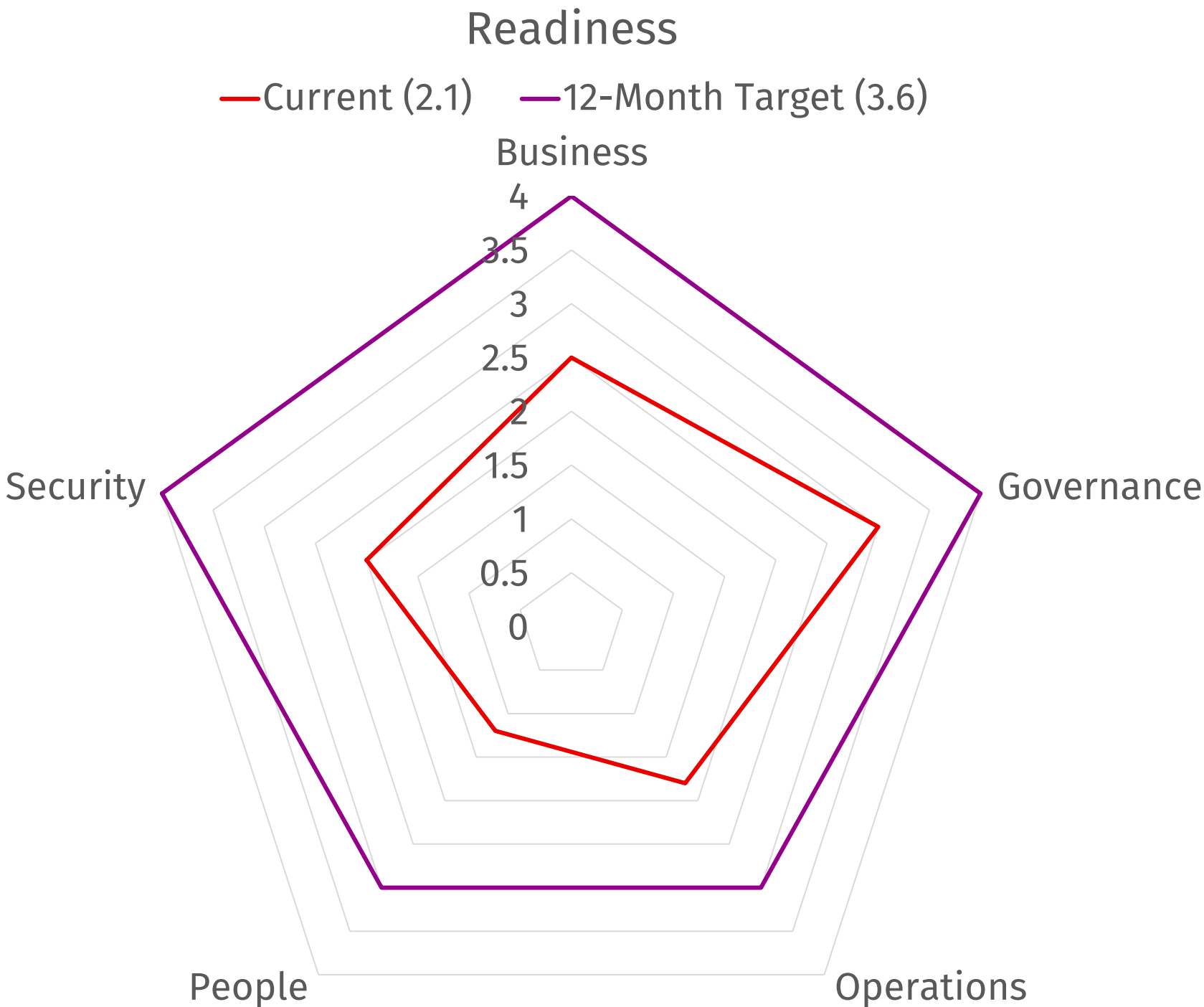
- DR planning is the critical gap: application owners could not clearly distinguish between HA, DR, and BCP (scored 1). Operating model, FinOps, and cost allocation all at early awareness stage (scored 2). Cloud-native DR patterns are a genuine uplift, not just a like-for-like move.

People (1.2), biggest gap, critical path

- Three of four sub-categories scored 1. No formal cloud training plan. No single-threaded senior leader assigned to oversee migration. Change management not socialised beyond awareness of the feasibility study. Without programme sponsorship, the other dimensions cannot improve. People is the critical path.

Closing the gap

Current state to 12-month target



What drives each improvement:

Business (2.5 to 4.0): Cloud strategy confirmed through this CRA. Business case lands with broader stakeholders on 5 May. Part 2 converts objectives into an execution plan with defined workloads and timelines.

Governance (3.0 to 4.0): Smallest gap. CMDB and portfolio governance already strong. Programme management formalises through Part 2 delivery partner engagement. Service delivery SLAs defined during migration planning.

Operations (1.8 to 3.0): Landing zone build establishes DR, infrastructure as code, and monitoring baselines from day one. Operating model defined with clear partner/customer boundaries. FinOps discipline introduced alongside cloud consumption. Sydney migration tests the model before the main estate moves.

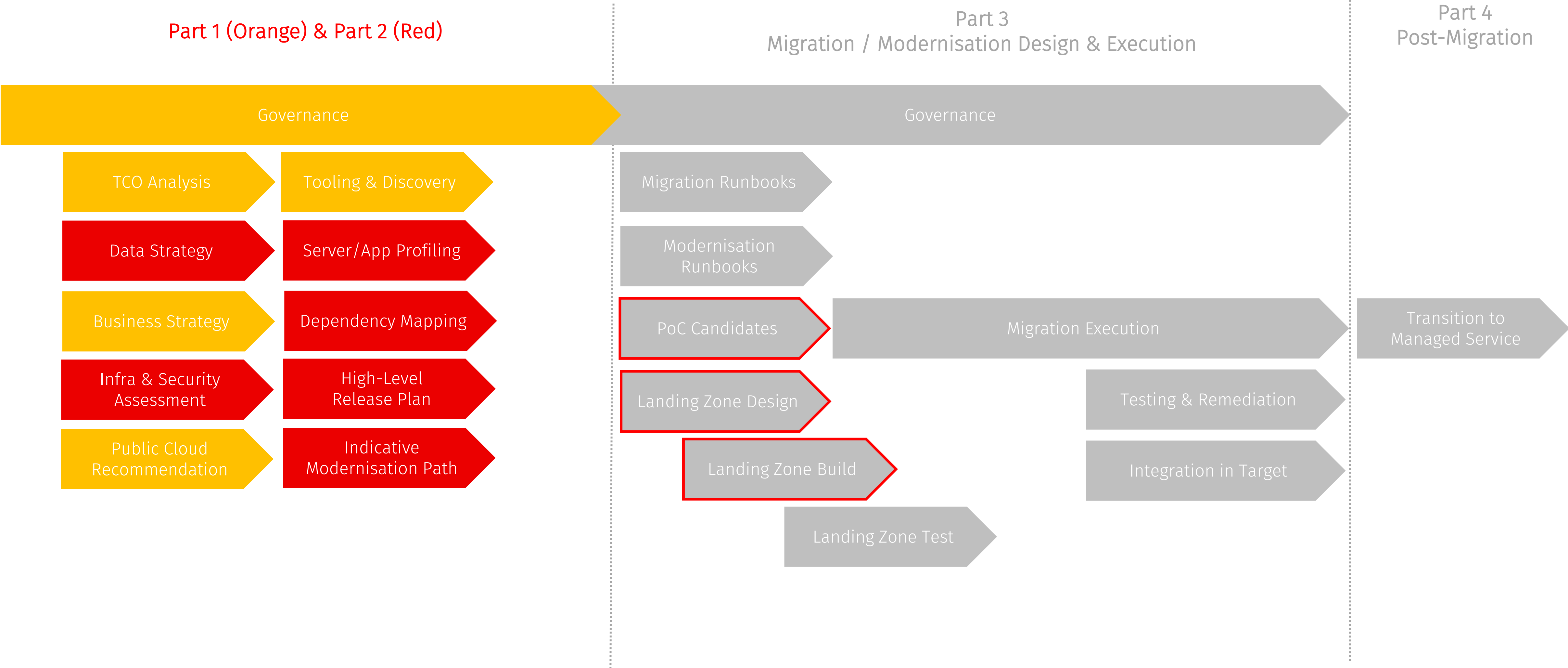
People (1.2 to 3.0): Largest gap, critical path. Requires three things: (a) named programme sponsor with CPO/CTO joint authority, (b) formal cloud training plan aligned to migration phases, (c) partner-assisted delivery where your team works alongside and absorbs capability cohort by cohort. Achievable with the right sponsorship. Will not happen by accident.

Security (2.0 to 4.0): Landing zone establishes IAM, compliance guardrails, and shared responsibility model from day one. NIST/CSF enforced, not just referenced. CISO engagement formalised into cloud security governance. Workspaces decision may change the security tooling landscape.

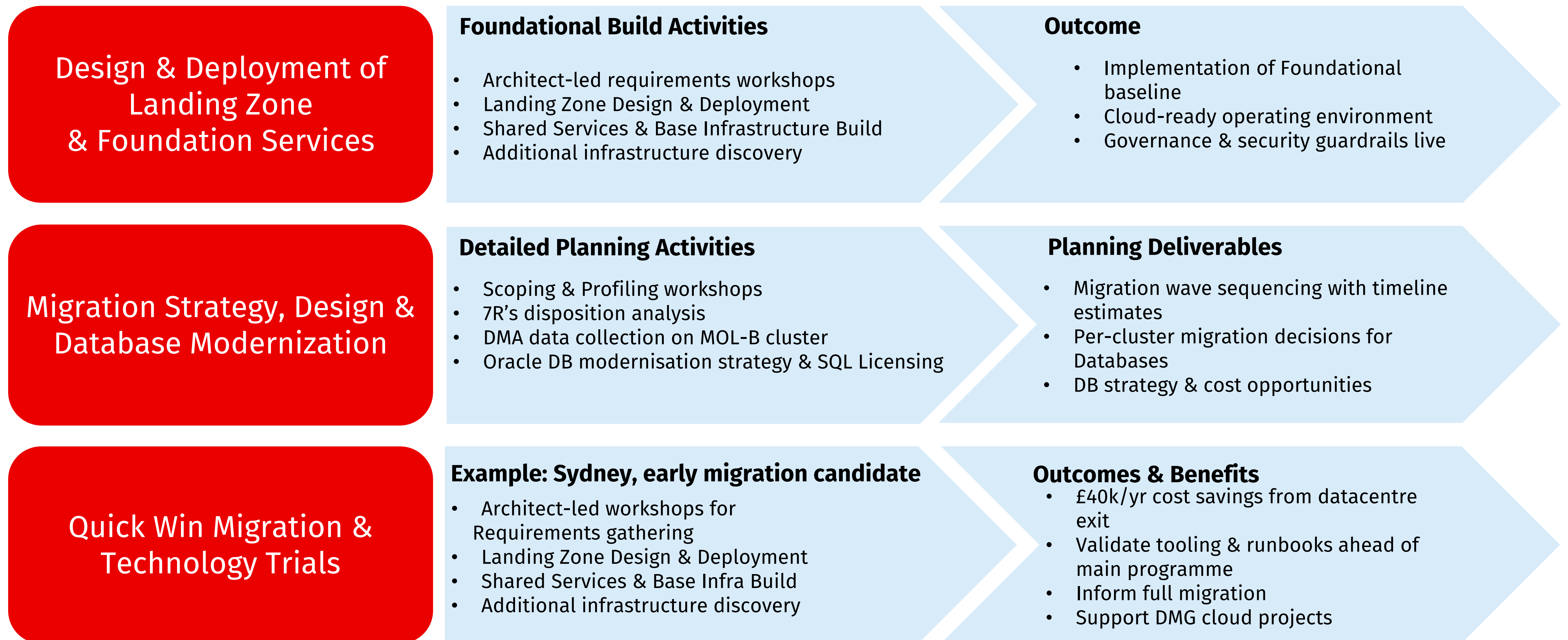
End state: Engineering self-sufficient within predefined infrastructure guardrails, with internal capability built in-flight.

Moving Forward and Part 2

High-level Plan – Cloud Readiness Assessment



Transformation Journey: Approach to CRA Part 2

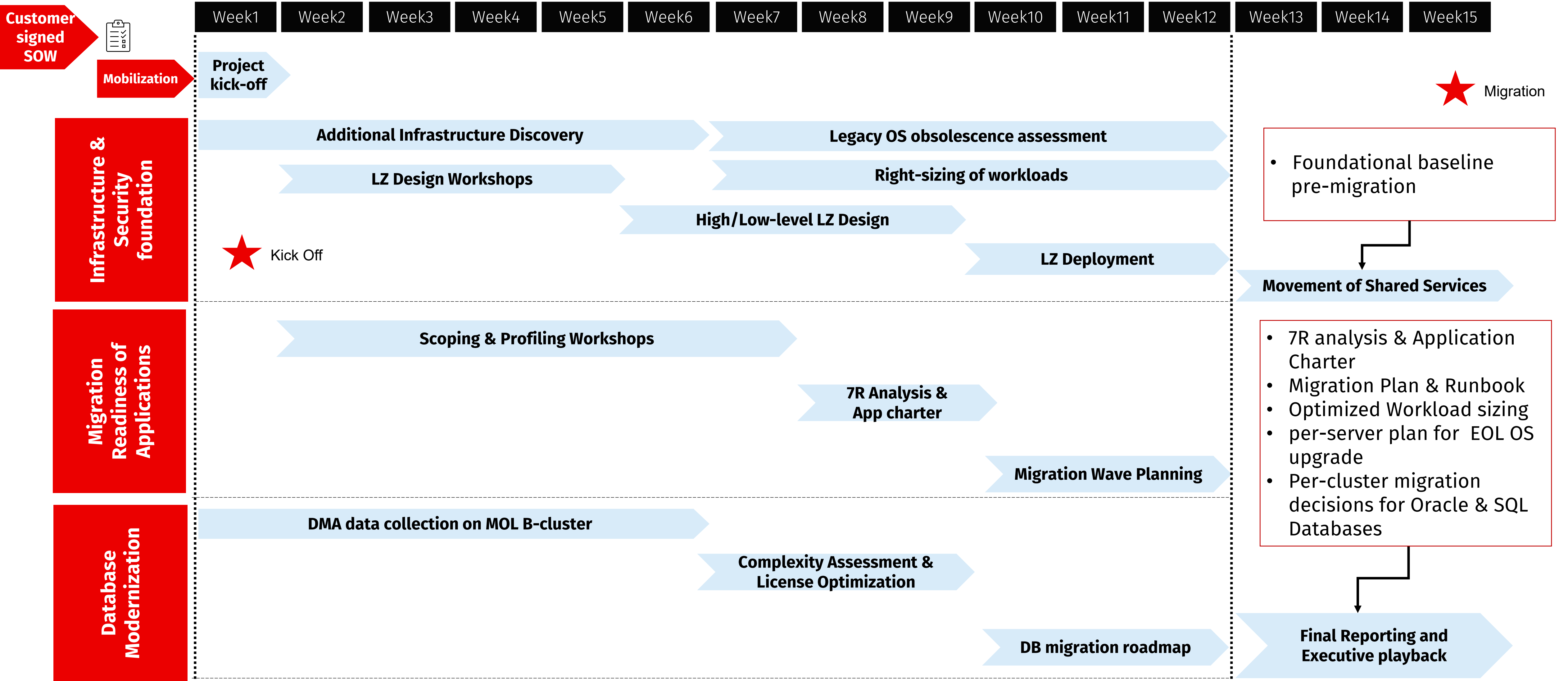


Dependencies & Pre-requisites

Data & Decisions required to proceed for CRA Phase 2

Required Data Points	Decisions to Make
D Broadcom VCF subscription quote	▶ Selection of primary cloud platform
D MOL B-cluster DMA access	▶ Vendor engagement with Atex on unicast support
DMG Actions Required	▶ Path forward for Oracle database
! Resolve infrastructure access issues	▶ CPO & CTO joint sponsorship for Mail Online
! VMware tooling configuration & agent deployment	▶ Day 2 operating model
! OS upgrades — unsupported versions will require remediation	

Cloud Readiness Assessment - Part 2



Conclusion & Next Steps

Conclusion

Why Cloud?
Why AWS?

For DMG Media, public
cloud addresses current
constraints in cost,
complexity, and scalability.

The estate is ready to move, with caveats. 3,038 servers profiled. 39 applications workshopped. The discovery and analysis is comprehensive enough to make a platform decision and plan the next phase. The caveats are real but addressable: 61% of the OS estate is end-of-life or unsupported, 1,227 servers have no VMware Tools. These define the migration sequence, not the platform decision.

AWS is the recommended platform. Weighted scoring: AWS 88%, GCP 85%, Azure 85%. AWS is the only platform that runs all 39 applications without refactoring. Native multicast support avoids the Atex redesign required on GCP and Azure. Existing AWS footprint (video streaming, Direct Connect, internal team knowledge) accelerates time to value. GCP is retained for commercial data analytics where it is already established.

Levers to reduce cost sit in cloud, not in the datacentre. The cloud figure carries forward operational costs (database support, security tooling) that reduce or disappear post-migration. The optimisation levers (contract negotiation, rightsizing, storage tiering, Oracle modernisation, PaaS adoption) exist in cloud.

The organisation is at the start of its cloud journey. Readiness score: 2.1 out of 5. Governance is the strongest area (3.0): CMDB maintained, app owners mapped, EA practice established. People is the biggest gap (1.2): no formal cloud training plan, no programme sponsor, change management not yet socialised. This is the critical path for Part 2.

Conclusion

The estate is well-profiled.
The organisation needs to get ready.

These things must be in place before Part 2 starts:

Confirm AWS as primary platform. This is the decision we are asking you to make. The scoring, technical fit, cost position, and estate constraints all point the same way. GCP is retained for analytics. Azure is not recommended.

Provide Broadcom VCF subscription quote. The VCF quote completes the on-prem cost baseline and closes the "cloud costs more" gap. The B-cluster DMA data covers the largest Oracle database in the estate, currently sized from hardware spec only. Both are needed before Part 2 can produce accurate migration plans.

Confirm CPO/CTO joint programme sponsorship. People readiness is at 1.2. Without a named sponsor with authority across both CPO and CTO domains, the training plan, change management, and operating model definition will not progress. This is the single biggest risk to the programme.

Quick wins to run in parallel with Part 2 planning: Sydney datacentre: 4 servers, flexible contract, £40K/yr. Independent applications with no Oracle dependency. These prove the model and deliver early value while the main estate is being planned.

Part 2 delivers the execution plan: 7R's position for all 39 apps, migration wave sequencing, dual-run cost modelling, landing zone design, database modernisation assessment, and per-server remediation plans for legacy OS. At the end of Part 2, there is no more talking. We start doing.

Next Steps

Before the hyperscaler sessions

- Provide Broadcom VCF subscription quote to complete the on-prem cost picture

Hyperscaler sessions (May)

- 12 May: Microsoft presentation (DMG offices & Remote, 14:00 to 16:00)
- 13 May: Google presentation (DMG offices & Remote, 11:00 to 13:00)
- 18 May: AWS presentation (AWS offices & Remote, 09:30 to 13:30)
- Use the discussion guidance and warning signs in this deck to evaluate each presentation against a consistent baseline

Following the hyperscaler sessions

- Confirm primary cloud platform decision (our recommendation: AWS, with GCP retained for analytics)
- Decisions to progress: Atex vendor engagement on unicast, Oracle path (Exadata now, PostgreSQL timing), CPO and CTO joint sponsorship for Mail Online, Day 2 operating model

Part 2 kick-off (target: June)

- Part 2 SOW to be issued following platform decision – before end of May
- 15-week programme: landing zone design, 7R analysis, migration planning, database modernisation assessment
- Sydney early migration and technology trials run in parallel from week 4

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